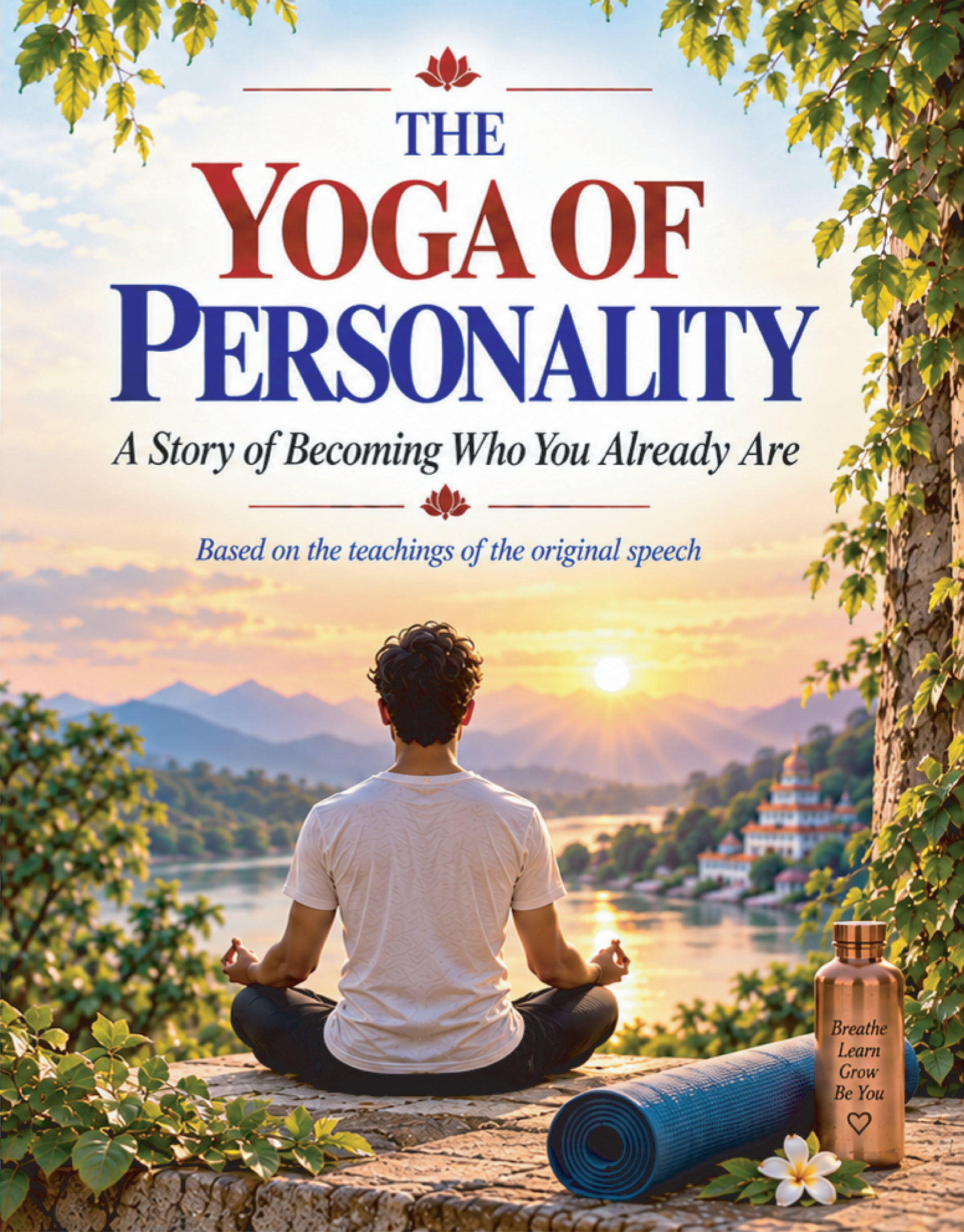
THE YOGA OF PERSONALITY

A Story of Becoming Who You Already Are

Based on the teachings of the original speech



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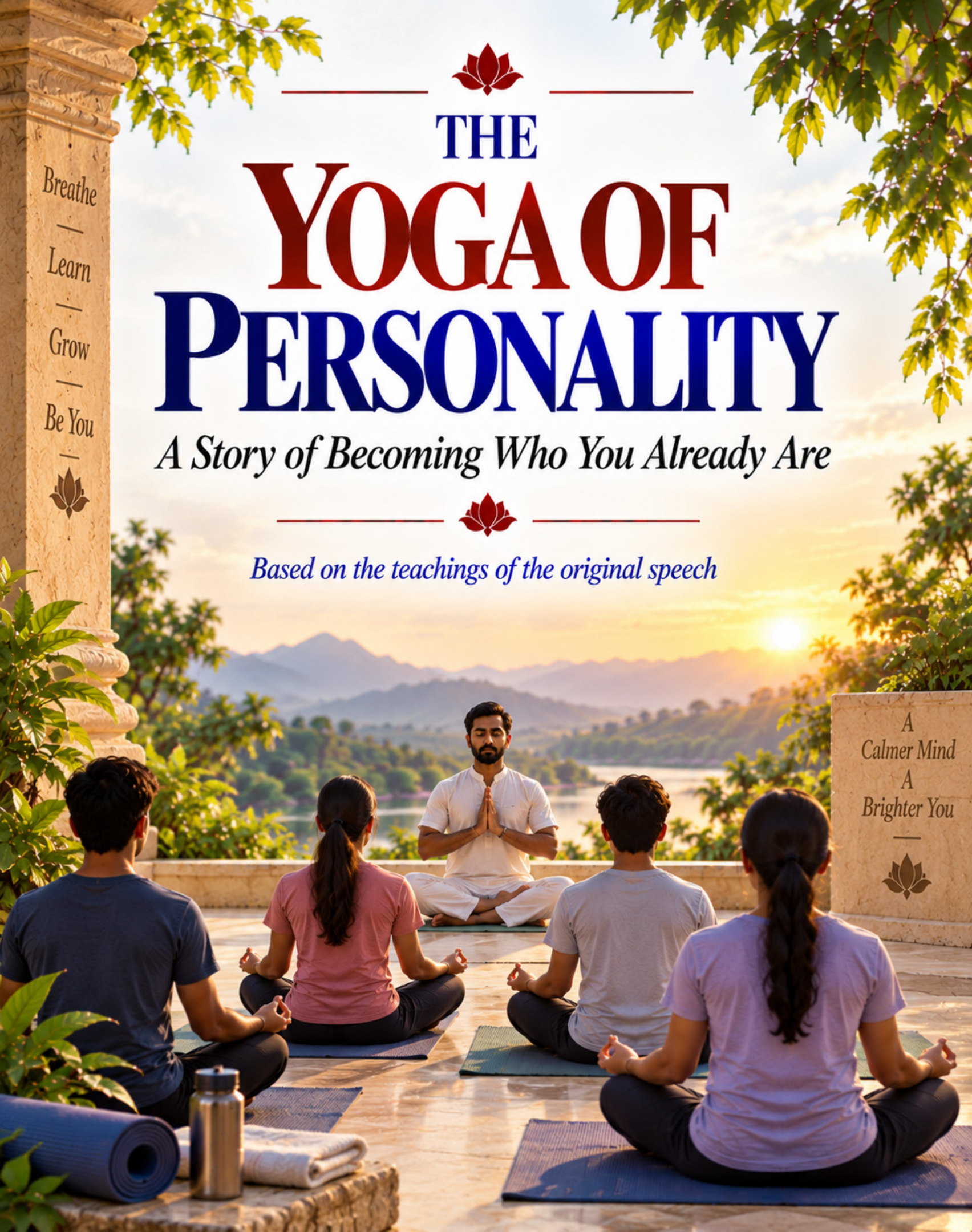


Dedication

To every cat who has been told to become a tiger.
To every human being who has forgotten their own uniqueness.
And to my mother, who first taught me that I was enough.

Same Journey A Brighter You

TABLE OF CONTENTS

PART ONE	**THE JUNGLE OF MIRRORS**	**Page No**
Chapter 1	The Man Who Wanted to Be Someone Else	1 - 2
Chapter 2	The Cat, The Deer, and The Monkey	3 - 5
Chapter 3	The Train to Rishikesh	6 - 7
PART TWO	**THE MASTER AND THE ASHRAM**	
Chapter 4	The Old Man with the Explosive Laugh	8 - 9
Chapter 5	The Injustice to the Creator	10 - 11
Chapter 6	The Layers of the Onion	12 - 14
PART THREE	**THE HEART OF YOGA**	
Chapter 7	Dvaita and Advaita	15 - 17
Chapter 8	The Lawyer Who Let Go	18 - 19
Chapter 9	The Pain That Expands You	20 - 21
PART FOUR	**THE PEAK OF PERSONALITY**	
Chapter 10	The Celebration That Needs No Reason	22 - 23
Chapter 11	The Return	24
Chapter 12	The Beginning	25 - 26
Epilogue: A Letter from Kailash Nath to Arun		27
Glossary of Sanskrit and Tamil Terms		28
About This Book		29

Same Humanity Brighter Possibilities

PART ONE:
THE JUNGLE OF MIRRORS

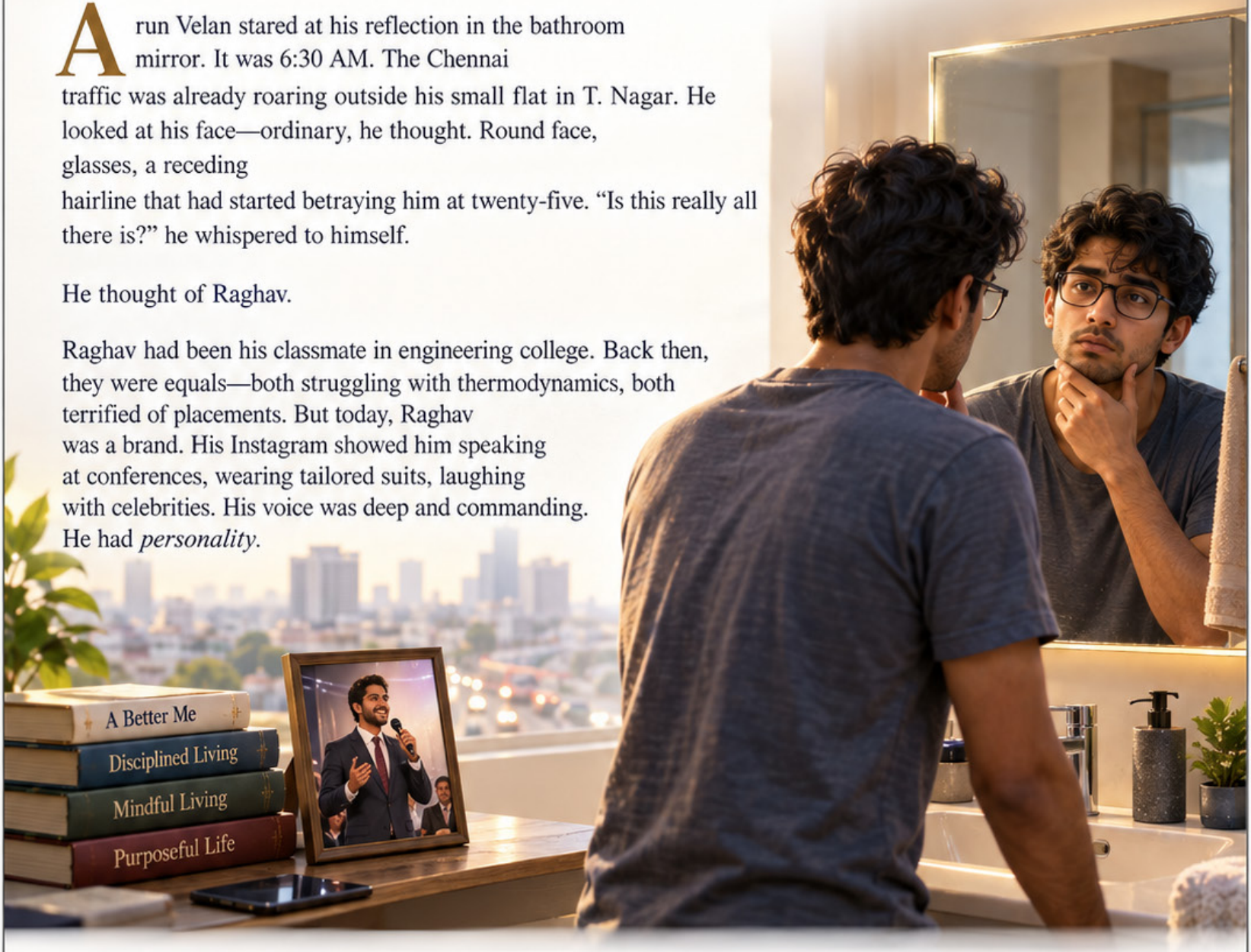
DISCOVER • REFLECT • REALIZE

Chapter 1:
The Man Who Wanted to Be Someone Else

Arun Velan stared at his reflection in the bathroom mirror. It was 6:30 AM. The Chennai traffic was already roaring outside his small flat in T. Nagar. He looked at his face—ordinary, he thought. Round face, glasses, a receding hairline that had started betraying him at twenty-five. "Is this really all there is?" he whispered to himself.

He thought of Raghav.

Raghav had been his classmate in engineering college. Back then, they were equals—both struggling with thermodynamics, both terrified of placements. But today, Raghav was a brand. His Instagram showed him speaking at conferences, wearing tailored suits, laughing with celebrities. His voice was deep and commanding. He had *personality*.



Arun, on the other hand, stumbled over words in meetings. His voice was soft. People interrupted him. At parties, he stood in corners, holding his drink, trying to think of something interesting to say. Nothing came. He felt invisible.

"Personality development," he muttered, scrolling through his phone. He had watched dozens of YouTube videos. He had tried to speak like Raghav. He had bought the same cologne. He had practiced power poses in his living room. Nothing worked. The more he tried to become someone else, the more painfully aware he became of who he was—or who he thought he was: *not enough*.

His mother, Meena, called from the kitchen. "Arun! Idli is getting cold!"

He sighed, turned off the light, and walked out. Another day of pretending. Another day of feeling like a cat trying to become a tiger.

Chapter 2:
The Cat, The Deer, and The Monkey

That evening, Arun sat with his mother on the balcony. The sun was setting over the crowded Chennai skyline. She was watering her tulsi plant. He was staring at his phone, watching another "How to Be Charismatic" video.

Meena glanced at him. "You've been watching those things for two years now. Tell me, have you become any happier?"

Arun looked up, surprised. "Ma, it's for my career. I need to develop my personality."

"Develop," she repeated, as if tasting the word. "To develop means to unfold what is already there. Tell me, beta—does a *cat want* to become a tiger?"

Arun laughed. "What kind of question is that? Of course not."

"Does a deer want to become a giraffe? Does a monkey want to become an elephant?"

"No, Ma. Animals are happy being what they are."

"Exactly," she said, sitting down beside him. "But you humans—you have always wanted to *become* somebody else. By design, human beings have always wanted to be something more than what they already are. That is your gift and your curse. The cat doesn't dream of being a tiger. The tiger doesn't dream of being a lion. But in the human jungle, everybody is wanting to mirror each other, wanting to avoid certain things from others, and wanting to imitate others."

Arun frowned. "So wanting to improve is wrong?"

"Wanting to *become* is not wrong," she said. "But wanting to become *someone* else is an insult to your creator. Your creator wanted you to be on this planet as *you are*—as this face, with this voice, with this possibility. In your DNA, it is already codified. In your brain, in your physique, everywhere it is already codified. All you need is to bring in some awareness."

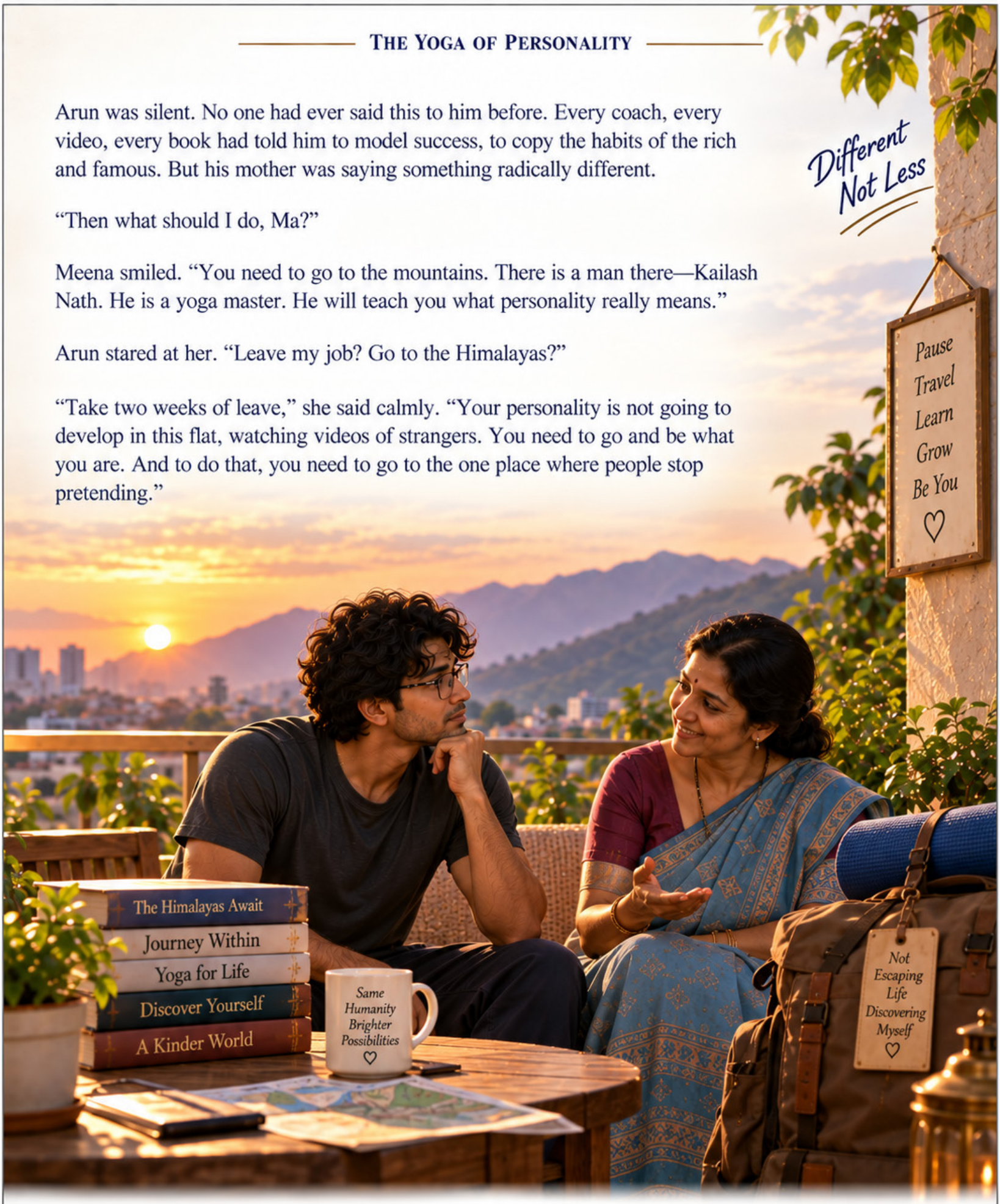
Arun was silent. No one had ever said this to him before. Every coach, every video, every book had told him to model success, to copy the habits of the rich and famous. But his mother was saying something radically different.

"Then what should I do, Ma?"

Meena smiled. "You need to go to the mountains. There is a man there—Kailash Nath. He is a yoga master. He will teach you what personality really means."

Arun stared at her. "Leave my job? Go to the Himalayas?"

"Take two weeks of leave," she said calmly. "Your personality is not going to develop in this flat, watching videos of strangers. You need to go and be what you are. And to do that, you need to go to the one place where people stop pretending."



Chapter 3:
The Train to Rishikesh

New Places New Perspectives

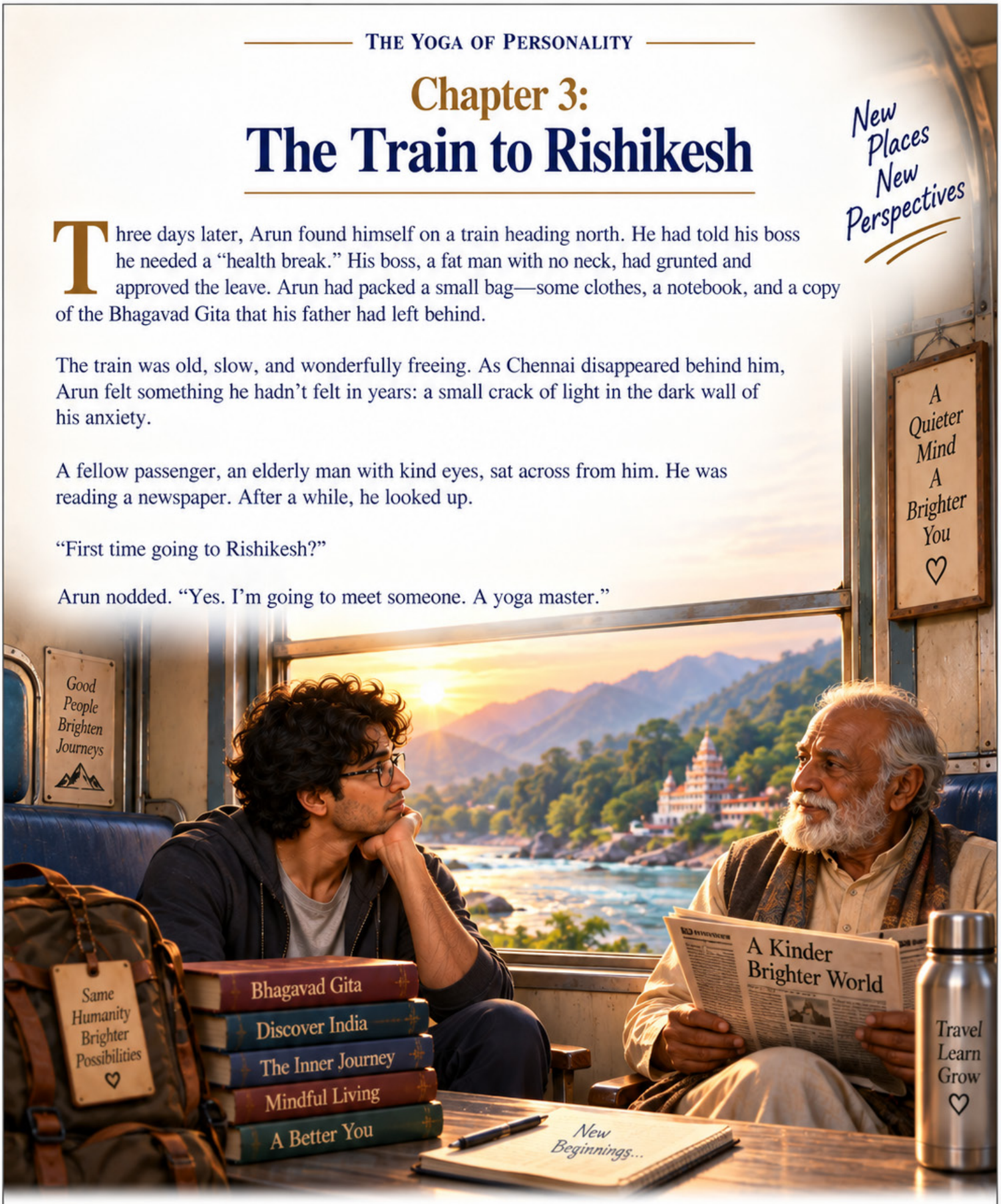
Three days later, Arun found himself on a train heading north. He had told his boss he needed a "health break." His boss, a fat man with no neck, had grunted and approved the leave. Arun had packed a small bag—some clothes, a notebook, and a copy of the Bhagavad Gita that his father had left behind.

The train was old, slow, and wonderfully freeing. As Chennai disappeared behind him, Arun felt something he hadn't felt in years: a small crack of light in the dark wall of his anxiety.

A fellow passenger, an elderly man with kind eyes, sat across from him. He was reading a newspaper. After a while, he looked up.

"First time going to Rishikesh?"

Arun nodded. "Yes. I'm going to meet someone. A yoga master."



"Ah," the man said, folding his newspaper. "Everyone goes to Rishikesh to find something. Some go to find God. Some go to find peace. Some go to find a better Instagram photo." He chuckled. "What are you going to find?"

Arun hesitated. "I don't know. A personality, I think."

The man raised an eyebrow. "A personality? My young friend, you already have a personality. The question is whether you are living it or fighting it."

Arun felt a shiver run down his spine. It was the same thing his mother had said. "How do I stop fighting it?"

The man looked out the window at the passing fields. "You cannot stop fighting something by fighting it. You stop fighting by surrendering. But not surrendering to someone else—surrendering to yourself. And that, my friend, is the hardest battle there is."

The train rattled on. Arun wrote in his notebook: "*Surrender to yourself.*" He didn't yet understand what it meant.

PART TWO: THE MASTER AND THE ASHRAM

Real People Real Transformation

Chapter 4:
The Old Man with the Explosive Laugh

The ashram was not what Arun had expected. He had imagined marble floors, golden statues, and incense thick enough to choke a horse. Instead, it was a cluster of simple stone buildings on a hill overlooking the Ganges. The river was gray-green and powerful. The air smelled of woodsmoke and flowers.

A young woman with short hair and a simple cotton kurta greeted him at the gate. "You must be Arun. I'm Devi. Kailashji said you were coming."

Arun blinked. "How did he know?"

Devi smiled. "He knows many things. Come, I'll show you where you'll sleep." As they walked, Arun asked, "How long have you been here?"

"Three years," she said. "Before that, I was a corporate lawyer in Mumbai. Seven hundred billable hours a quarter. My blood pressure was 160 over 100. I thought I had everything. I had no personality at all—just a mask that billed by the hour."

Arun felt an immediate kinship. "And now?"

She stopped walking. "Now I'm learning what it means to be a co-creator. Now I'm learning that personality is not about impressing anyone. It's about expressing everything."

Before Arun could ask more, a sound boomed across the ashram. It was a laugh—not a polite chuckle, but a full-bodied, belly-shaking, thunderous laugh that seemed to come from the earth itself.

"There he is," Devi said. "Kailash Nath."

They rounded a corner and saw him. Kailash Nath was ancient but vibrant—a white beard, eyes that sparkled like black diamonds, and bare feet that seemed to grip the earth with intention. He was sitting under a banyan tree, drinking chai from a clay cup. When he saw Arun, he grinned.

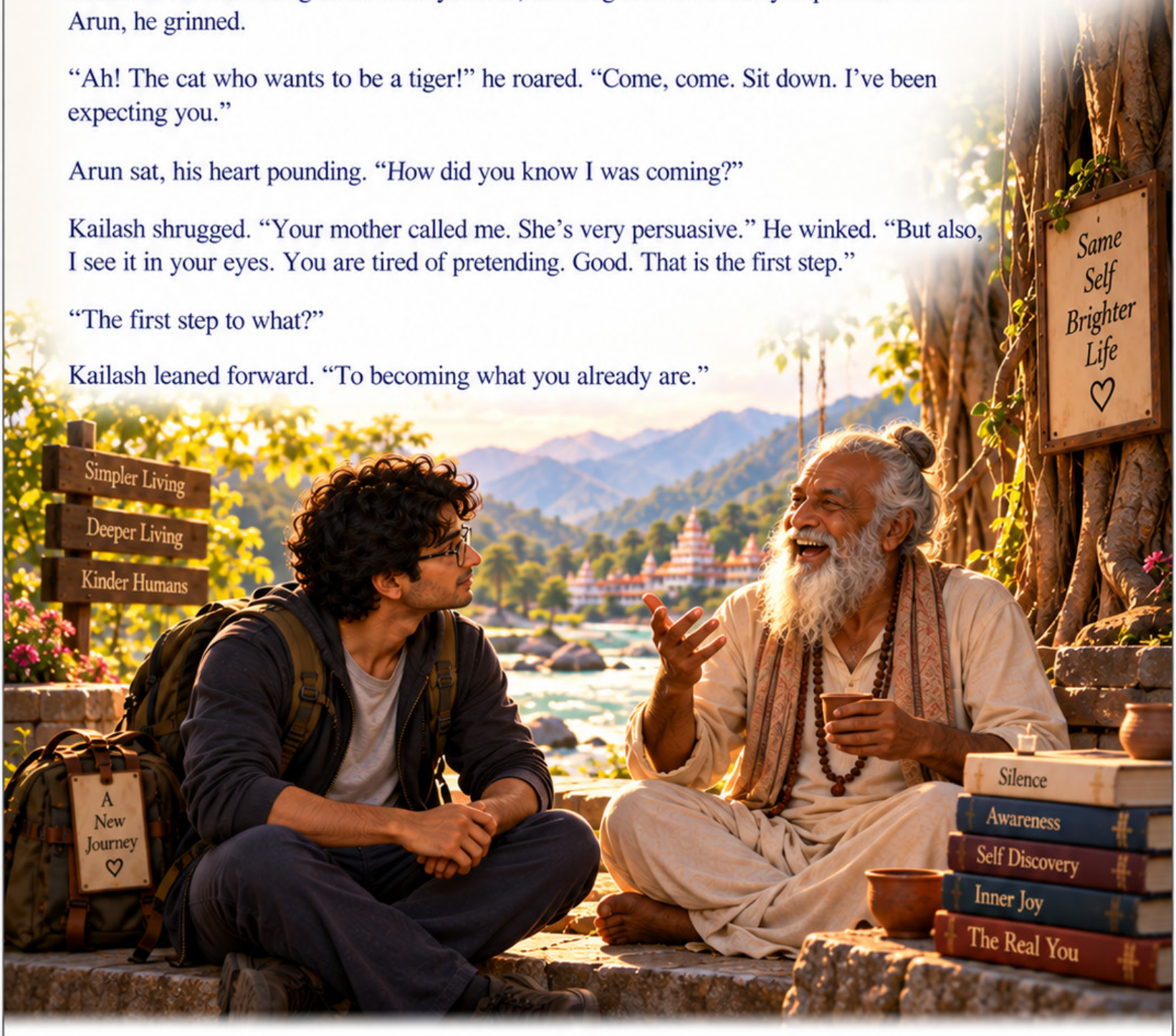
"Ah! The cat who wants to be a tiger!" he roared. "Come, come. Sit down. I've been expecting you."

Arun sat, his heart pounding. "How did you know I was coming?"

Kailash shrugged. "Your mother called me. She's very persuasive." He winked. "But also, I see it in your eyes. You are tired of pretending. Good. That is the first step."

"The first step to what?"

Kailash leaned forward. "To becoming what you already are."



Chapter 5:
The Injustice to the Creator

Be You That's enough

That evening, all the ashram residents and visitors gathered in a stone courtyard. A small fire burned in the center. Kailash Nath sat on a raised platform, his legs folded, his eyes closed. When everyone was silent, he opened his eyes and began to speak.

Arun took out his notebook. What followed was a teaching that would change everything.

"In my opinion," Kailash began, his voice soft but carrying, "personality is first of all to go and be what you are. You are supposed to be doing a big injustice to your creator when you try to be someone else. You are insulting your creator. Your creator wanted you to be on this planet as you are—as this face, with this voice, with this possibility, in this human dimension."

He paused and looked directly at Arun. "That creator has given you exclusively some uniqueness. You are a truly unique being on this planet. Just enjoy that uniqueness. You are the best of the personalities you are."

Arun felt tears prick his eyes. No one had ever called him unique. No one had ever told him he was already the best.

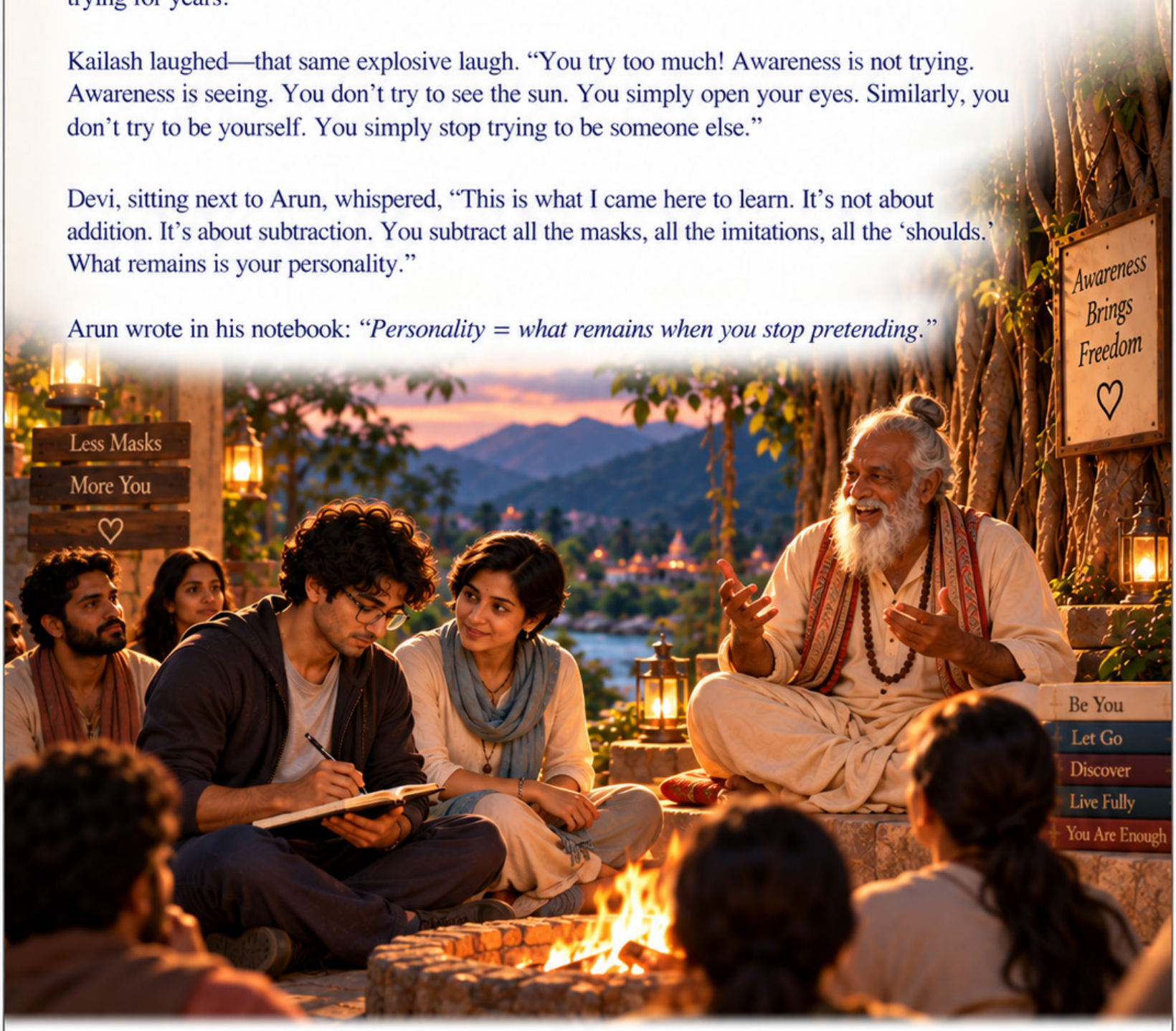
Kailash continued. "Your creator has given you everything that you want to be on this planet. In your DNA, it is already codified. In your brain, in your physique, everywhere it is already codified. All that you need to know is to bring in some awareness."

A man in the back raised his hand. "But Guruji, how do we bring that awareness? We've been trying for years!"

Kailash laughed—that same explosive laugh. "You try too much! Awareness is not trying. Awareness is seeing. You don't try to see the sun. You simply open your eyes. Similarly, you don't try to be yourself. You simply stop trying to be someone else."

Devi, sitting next to Arun, whispered, "This is what I came here to learn. It's not about addition. It's about subtraction. You subtract all the masks, all the imitations, all the 'shoulds.' What remains is your personality."

Arun wrote in his notebook: *"Personality = what remains when you stop pretending."*



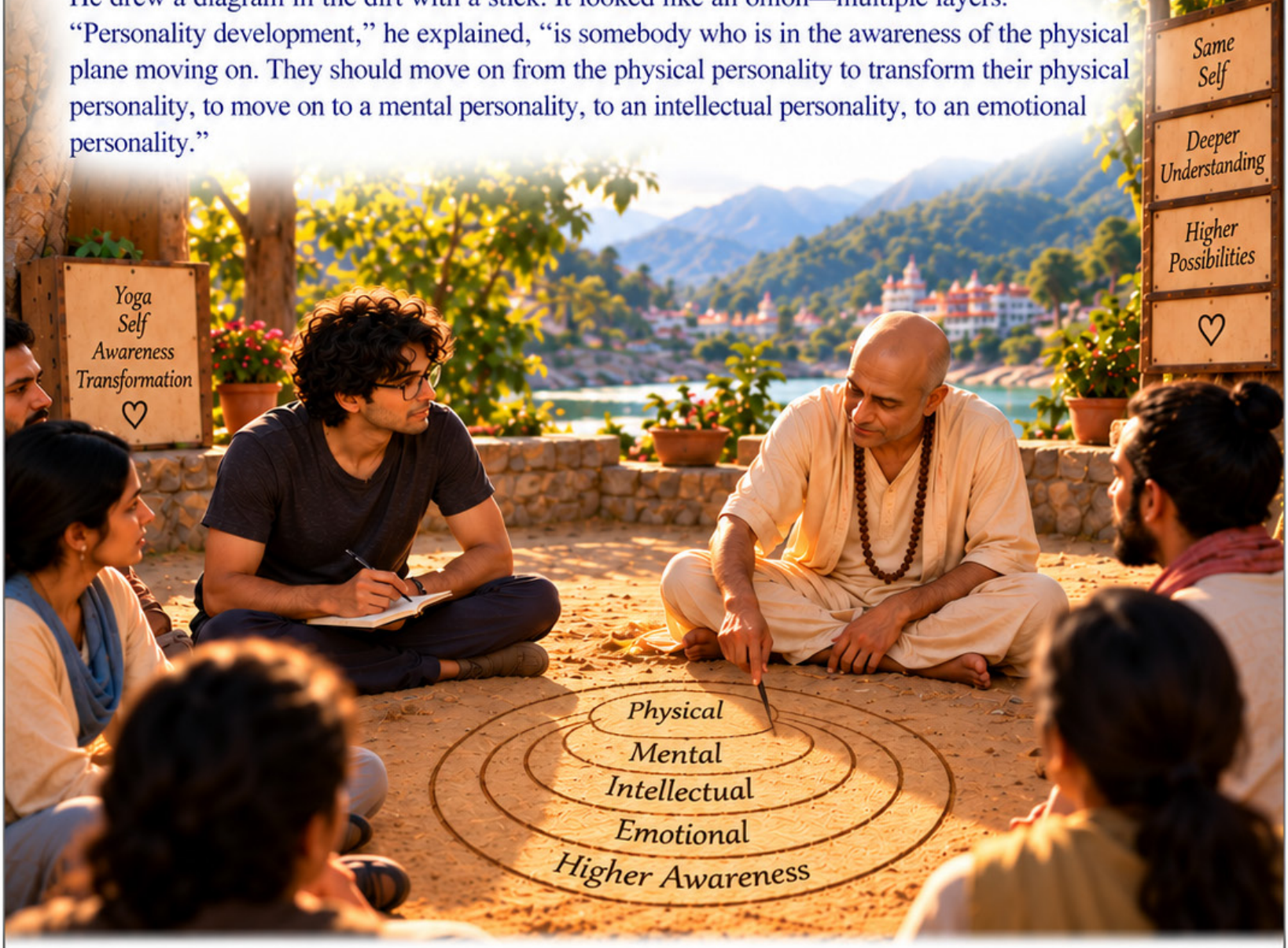
Chapter 6:
The Layers of the Onion

Higher Awareness A Fuller You

The next morning, Swami Chaitanya—a thin, bald man with a gentle voice—taught the morning class. They sat in a circle. Arun was still stiff from his first yoga session the previous day. His hamstrings screamed.

"Yoga," Swami Chaitanya said, "is the only science available for humanity to see transformation—to see the positive ability of a human being to go further, to go from a lower level to the next level, from a lower realm of energy to the next realm of energy."

He drew a diagram in the dirt with a stick. It looked like an onion—multiple layers. "Personality development," he explained, "is somebody who is in the awareness of the physical plane moving on. They should move on from the physical personality to transform their physical personality, to move on to a mental personality, to an intellectual personality, to an emotional personality."



Arun raised his hand. "What's the difference between mental and intellectual?"

"Good question," Swami Chaitanya smiled. "The mental personality thinks. The intellectual personality discerns. The mind collects; the intellect distinguishes between what is true and false, what is temporary and eternal. And beyond both is the emotional personality—not sentimentality, but the capacity to feel deeply and appropriately."

Go Deeper Discover Your True Self

Devi added, "Most people live only in the physical personality—their looks, their clothes, their voice. That's why they're so fragile. One criticism and they shatter."

Swami Chaitanya nodded. "Yoga moves you inward, through each layer, until you reach the core. And what is at the core? Not a personality. Something far greater. But we will come to that."

That afternoon, Arun practiced yoga postures for the first time in his life. He was terrible at it. He couldn't touch his toes. He fell over in tree pose. His downward dog looked more like a dying caterpillar.

Embrace The Process You Grow Stronger

But Kailash Nath, who watched from the side, only laughed. "Good! Good! The pain is your teacher. When you accept the pain, there is a little expansion in your physical ability, your mental ability. You are able to connect and control."

Arun, sweating and trembling in a lunge, gasped, "Connect what?"

"Your breath to your body. Your mind to your breath. Your awareness to your mind. And eventually, your inner world to the outer world."

PART THREE: THE HEART OF YOGA

Chapter 7:
Dvaita and Advaita

From Separation to Oneness

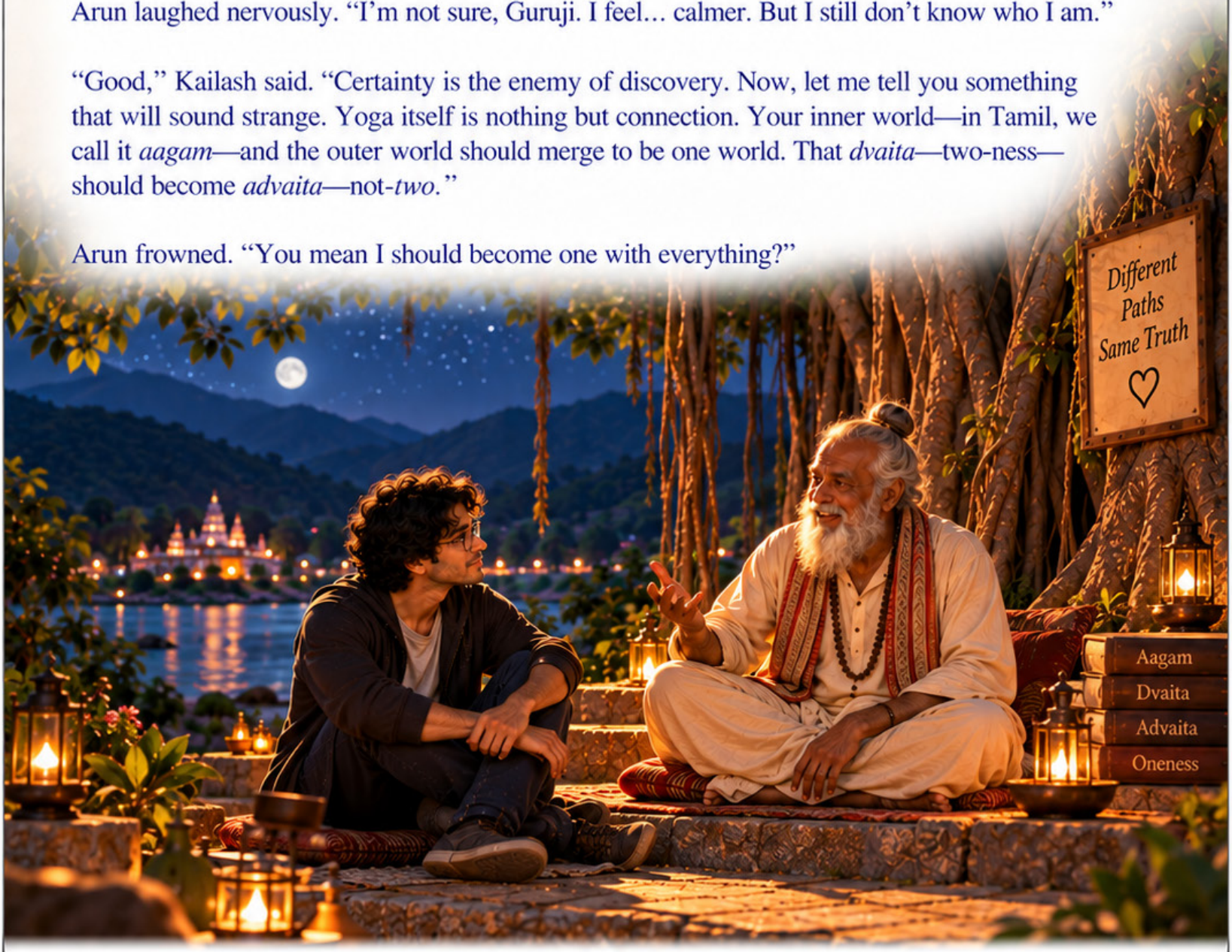
One evening, after the fire had been lit and the chanting had ended, Kailash Nath called Arun to sit beside him under the banyan tree. The stars were out. The Ganges murmured below.

"You've been here a week," Kailash said. "Have you found your personality yet?"

Arun laughed nervously. "I'm not sure, Guruji. I feel… calmer. But I still don't know who I am."

"Good," Kailash said. "Certainty is the enemy of discovery. Now, let me tell you something that will sound strange. Yoga itself is nothing but connection. Your inner world—in Tamil, we call it *aagam*—and the outer world should merge to be one world. That *dvaita*—two-ness—should become *advaita*—not-*two*."

Arun frowned. "You mean I should become one with everything?"



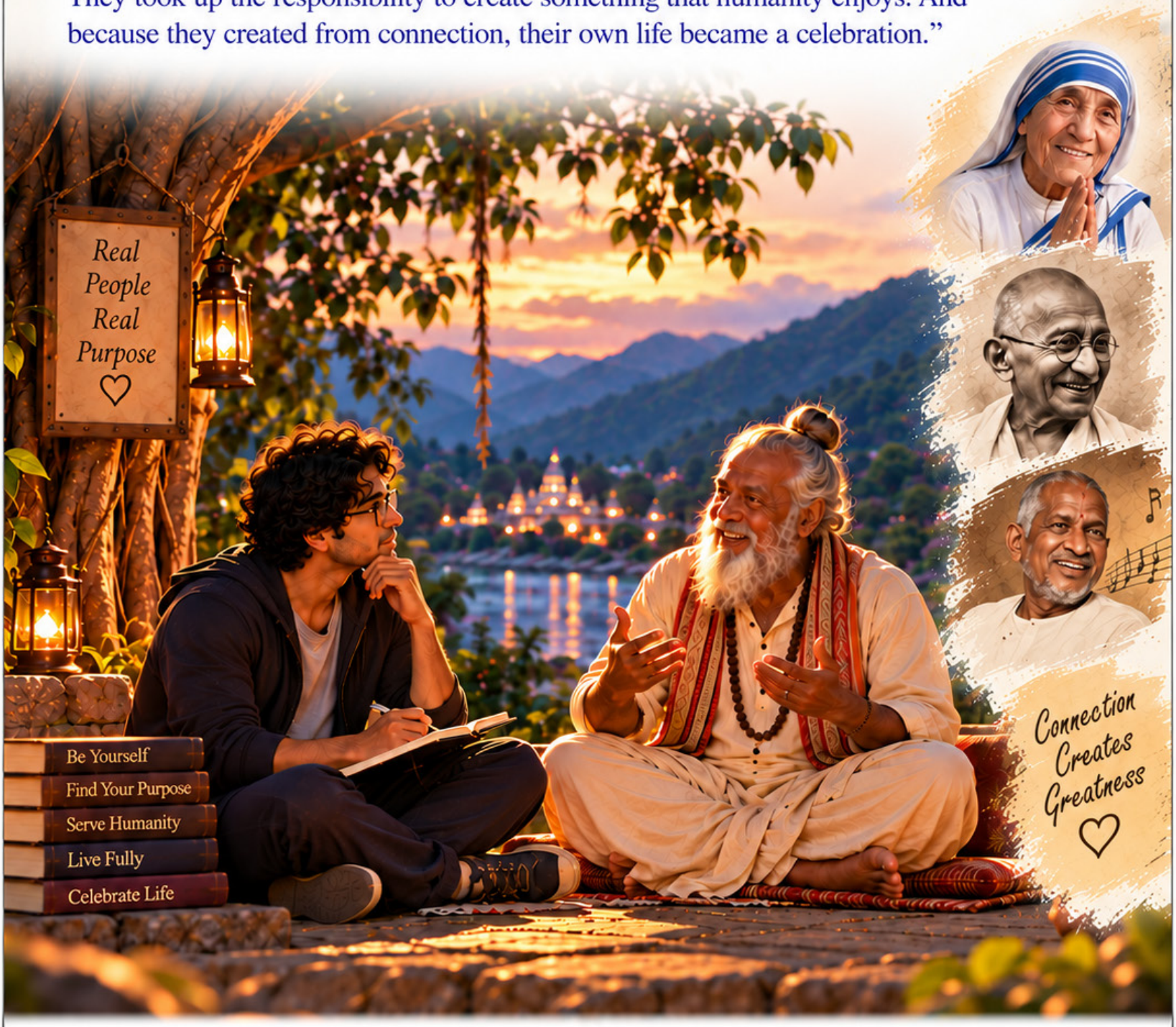
Kailash shrugged. "Not *should*. *Can*. This is the possibility of the human being. A cat cannot do this. A deer cannot. A monkey cannot. But you? You have been given this human body—the only body which can experience and express *Ananda*—that bliss part of it which can be enjoyed in the human body."

Connect Within Connect Everywhere

He picked up a clay cup. "See this cup? If I put a SIM card in it, can I make a phone call? No. I need a phone. I need towers. I need a connection. Similarly, you have the divine inside you—the SIM card of your soul. But you need the science of yoga to connect. Every yoga practice—whether it's a posture, a breathing exercise, a chant, or a meditation—is only a signal to the creator and the creation within us."

Arun sat with this for a long time. Finally, he asked, "So personality development is really about... connection?"

Kailash beamed. "Now you are beginning to understand. Celebrated personalities such as Mother Teresa, Mahatma Gandhi, and a musician like Ilaiyaraaja are celebrated not because they imitated someone. They are celebrated because they were connected to their very own being and expressed themselves in totality. They took up the responsibility to create something that humanity enjoys. And because they created from connection, their own life became a celebration."



A Happier You Creates a Brighter World

Chapter 8:
The Lawyer Who Let Go

Do Everything From Happiness Not for Happiness

The next day, Arun found Devi sitting by the river, skipping stones. He sat beside her. "Can I ask you something personal?"

She nodded. "Of course."

"You were a successful lawyer. You had money, status, a future. Why did you leave all that?"

Devi was silent for a moment. Then she said, "Because I was doing everything for happiness. I thought if I got the next promotion, bought the next bag, went on the next vacation, I would be happy. But I was never happy. I was always chasing. And then I read something that changed my life. It said: 'Do everything from the space of happiness, *not for* happiness.'"

Arun repeated the words slowly. "Do everything from happiness, *not for* happiness."

"Yes," she said. "If you are doing yoga for happiness, you are not there. You do yoga happily. You eat happily. You talk happily. You listen happily. You do things happily. And in that happiness, you do creation happily. And in your creation, you do celebration."

Arun thought of his job. He did it for the salary, for the approval, for the fear of being fired. He never did it happily. He did it anxiously.

"How do I shift?" he asked.

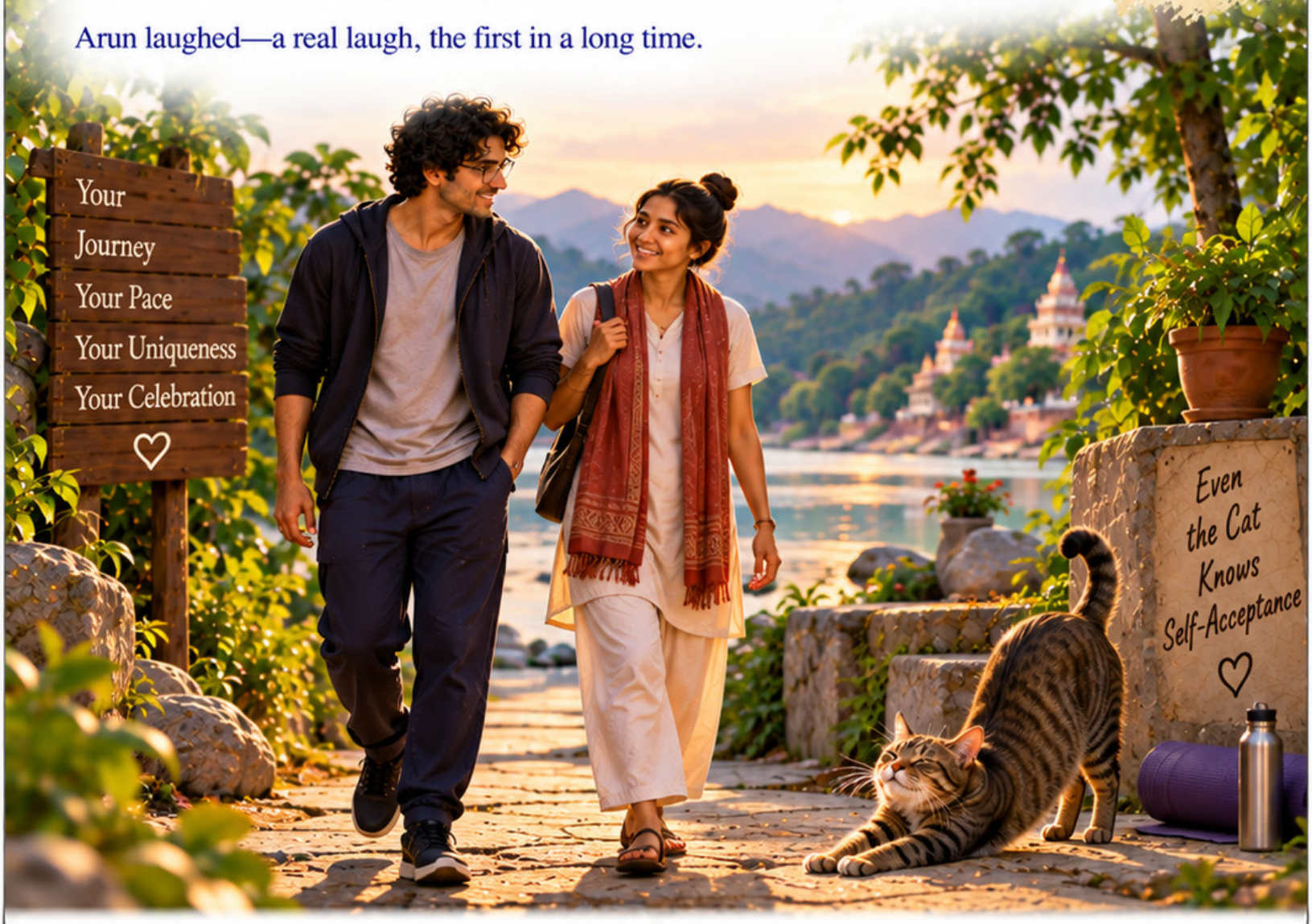
Devi smiled. "You stop measuring yourself against Raghav."

Arun froze. "How do you know about Raghav?"

"Because you talk in your sleep," she laughed. "But also because everyone who comes here has a Raghav. Someone they compare themselves to. Someone they want to become. The first step of yoga is to see that you are not Raghav. You are Arun. And Arun has a unique possibility that Raghav will never have."

She stood up. "Now come. Kailashji wants us to practice a posture called the cat stretch. He said to tell you: 'Even the cat has more self-acceptance than you.'"

Arun laughed—a real laugh, the first in a long time.



Chapter 9:
The Pain That Expands You

That afternoon's yoga practice was brutal. Kailash Nath himself led it. He had them hold postures for what felt like hours. Arun's arms shook. His thighs burned. His lower back ached.

"Don't run from the pain," Kailash boomed. "The pain is the door. When you accept the pain, you expand. When you expand, you connect. When you connect, you control."

Arun wanted to scream. He wanted to collapse. But he stayed. He breathed. He felt the pain like a fire, and instead of fleeing, he walked into it.

And then, something shifted.

The pain didn't disappear. But it stopped being his enemy. It became a sensation—just another wave in the ocean of his experience. And in that moment, he felt a connection between his breath, his body, and something larger. Something he couldn't name.

After the practice, Kailash Nath sat beside him. "You felt it, didn't you?" Arun nodded, unable to speak.

"That is the beginning," Kailash said quietly. "The more you are able to connect and control within yourself, the more you will be able to connect and control things in the world outside. The more connection you have to the breathing within yourself, the more connection you will have with the world outside."

Arun wiped sweat from his forehead. "Is this what they mean by 'personality'? This feeling?"

Kailash shook his head. "This feeling is only the doorway. Personality is what walks through the doorway and expresses itself in the world. Every yoga posture has something to do with connection and control. And through this, you will be able to create."

"Create what?"

"Whatever you are here to create. You are not here to consume. You are not here to imitate. You are here as a co-creator. The personality you are supposed to be is a co-creator on this planet. To be a co-creator, you need to be your very best. And with your very best, you need to express yourself with the very best of creativity."

You Are Not Here to Consume. You Are Here to Create. ♡

PART FOUR:
THE PEAK OF PERSONALITY

Not
A Happier
You,
A More
Awake You

Be
Connected
Create
Contribute
Celebrate

Chapter 10:
The Celebration That Needs No Reason

On his final day at the ashram, Arun woke before sunrise. He walked to the Ganges and sat on a cold stone. The river flowed past him, ancient and indifferent and alive. For the first time in his life, he felt no urge to check his phone. No urge to compare himself to anyone. No urge to become someone else.

He simply sat. And in that sitting, he felt something he had never felt before: a quiet, steady happiness that asked for nothing. It wasn't excitement. It wasn't pleasure. It was deeper. It was Ananda.

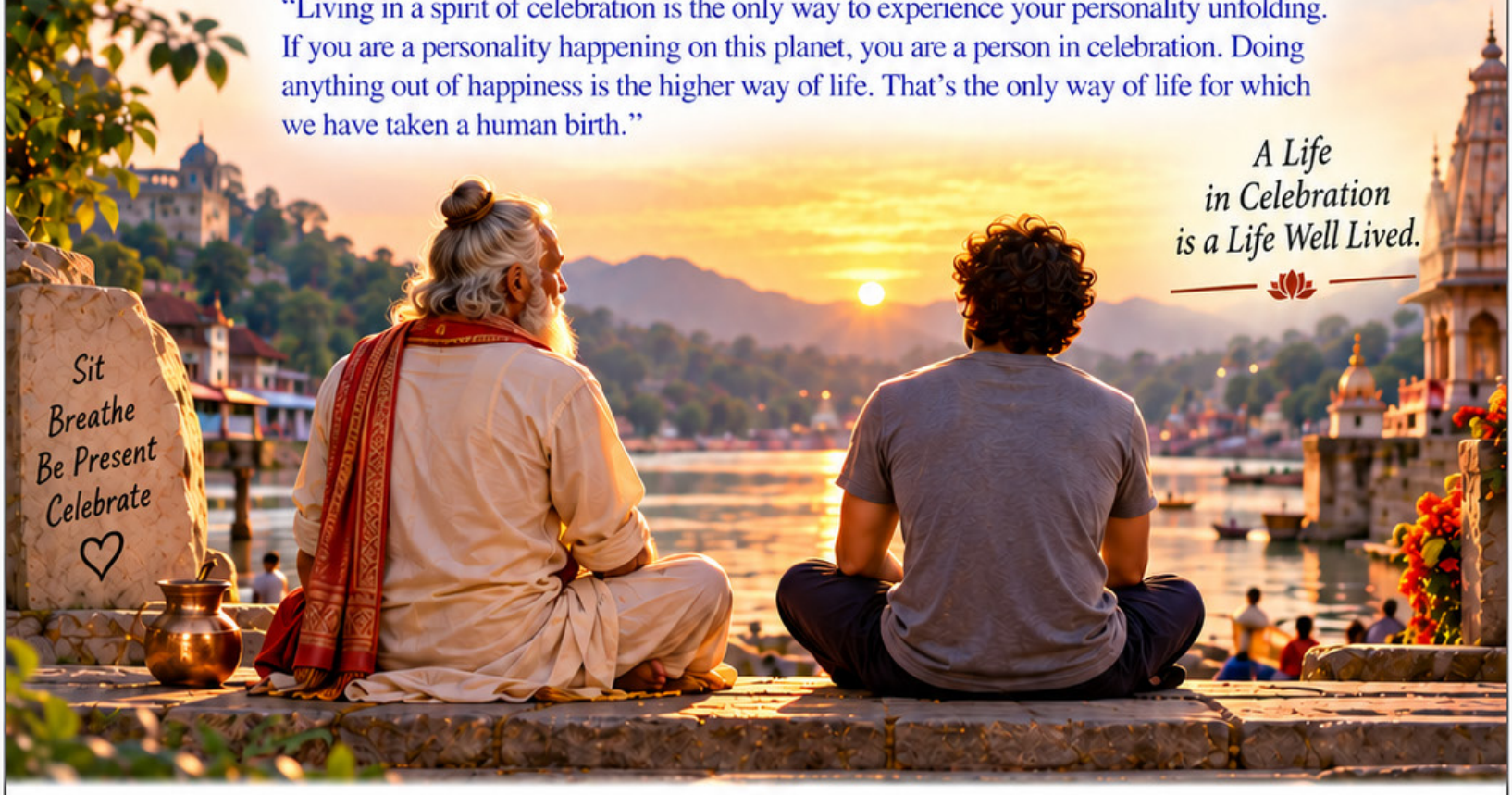
Kailash Nath appeared beside him, silent as a shadow. "You are ready," the old man said.

"For what?"

"To hear the final teaching."

They sat together as the sun rose, painting the river gold. Kailash spoke softly.

"Living in a spirit of celebration is the only way to experience your personality unfolding. If you are a personality happening on this planet, you are a person in celebration. Doing anything out of happiness is the higher way of life. That's the only way of life for which we have taken a human birth."



Arun turned to him. "But Guruji, how do I stay in celebration when I go back to Chennai? When I see Raghav's Instagram? When my boss yells at me?"

Kailash smiled. "You ask the right question. The answer is: you don't stay in celebration. You return to celebration. Again and again. Every time you fall into comparison, you return. Every time you forget who you are, you remember. This is the practice. This is the yoga."

He placed a hand on Arun's shoulder. "Anyone who is in creation and celebration is at the peak of their personality. And in that peak of personality, you have lived up to your creator's expectation. The creator himself will co-create with you and celebrate life with you. That is the one and only space for which you have taken this very human birth."

Return
Again and
Again.

That Is
the Practice.
That Is
the Yoga.

Same You. A Brighter Way Forward.

Chapter 11: The Return

The train ride back to Chennai was different. Arun sat by the window, watching the landscape change from mountains to plains to the familiar chaos of Tamil Nadu. He didn't scroll through his phone. He didn't rehearse conversations in his head. He just breathed. He just was.

When he reached home, his mother opened the door. She looked at him. He looked at her. She didn't ask if he had changed. She simply smiled and said, "Welcome back, beta."

That night, Raghav called. "Dude! Where have you been? There's a big conference next week. I can get you a pass. You need to network. You need to be seen."

Arun held the phone. The old anxiety rose in his chest—the familiar ache of not being enough. But then he breathed. He remembered the pain that expands. He remembered the cat that doesn't want to be a tiger.

"Thanks, Raghav," he said calmly. "But I don't need to be seen anymore. I'm going to do my work. And I'm going to do it happily."

Raghav laughed, confused. "What does that even mean?"

Arun smiled. "It means I'm done becoming you. I'm becoming me."

He hung up. His mother, in the kitchen, pretended not to have heard. But he saw her smile.

Not to Be Seen. But to Be Yourself.

Chapter 12:
The Beginning

Same Work. A New You. From Happiness. ♡

The book does not end with Arun becoming a famous speaker, a billionaire, or a guru. He returns to his cubicle. He writes code. He eats lunch. He visits his mother. He argues with auto-rickshaw drivers. He lives.

But something is different. He no longer does things *for* happiness. He does them *from* happiness. When his boss criticizes him, he listens without crumbling. When he sees someone more successful, he feels joy for them instead of envy. When he looks in the mirror, he sees not an ordinary face, but a unique expression of the creator.

Some nights, he sits on his balcony and watches the Chennai stars—dim, but still there. And he remembers Kailash Nath's final words:

"You might do yoga like a monkey or a donkey or a dog or a cat or a lion. Everything is possible to be imbibed in the human body with all your practices. In any form of yoga—Rama Yoga, Laya Yoga, Bhakti Yoga, Kriya Yoga, Jnana Yoga, Hatha Yoga—everything culminates only to the one thing: that we as humans have a higher possibility to enjoy the bliss and the Ananda in our very being and express ourselves in totality."

Be
A More
You
A Kinder
You
A Happier
You

Arun Velan is not a celebrity. He is not a saint. He is not the next Mahatma Gandhi or Sachin Tendulkar. He is simply a man who stopped trying to be a tiger and learned to be a magnificent cat.

And that, Kailash Nath would say, is the only personality development that matters.

EPILOGUE

A Letter from Kailash Nath to Arun

Live
Create
Contribute
Celebrate

My dear Arun,

You asked me once, "What is the purpose of all this?" I did not answer then, because the answer must be lived, not spoken. But now, perhaps, you are ready to hear it.

We are here to create this planet along with our creator. We are co-creators. The personality that you are supposed to be is a co-creator on this planet. When connectivity and creativity happen within yourself—and that can happen only when you have a connection with the creator—then you emerge to be the peak possibility of a new humanity.

Do not look for this in grand gestures. Look for it in the small things: the way you make your mother laugh, the way you hold the door for a stranger, the way you write a single line of beautiful code, the way you forgive yourself for your failures.

Love is the only yoga that never ends. And you, Arun, are loved more than you know.

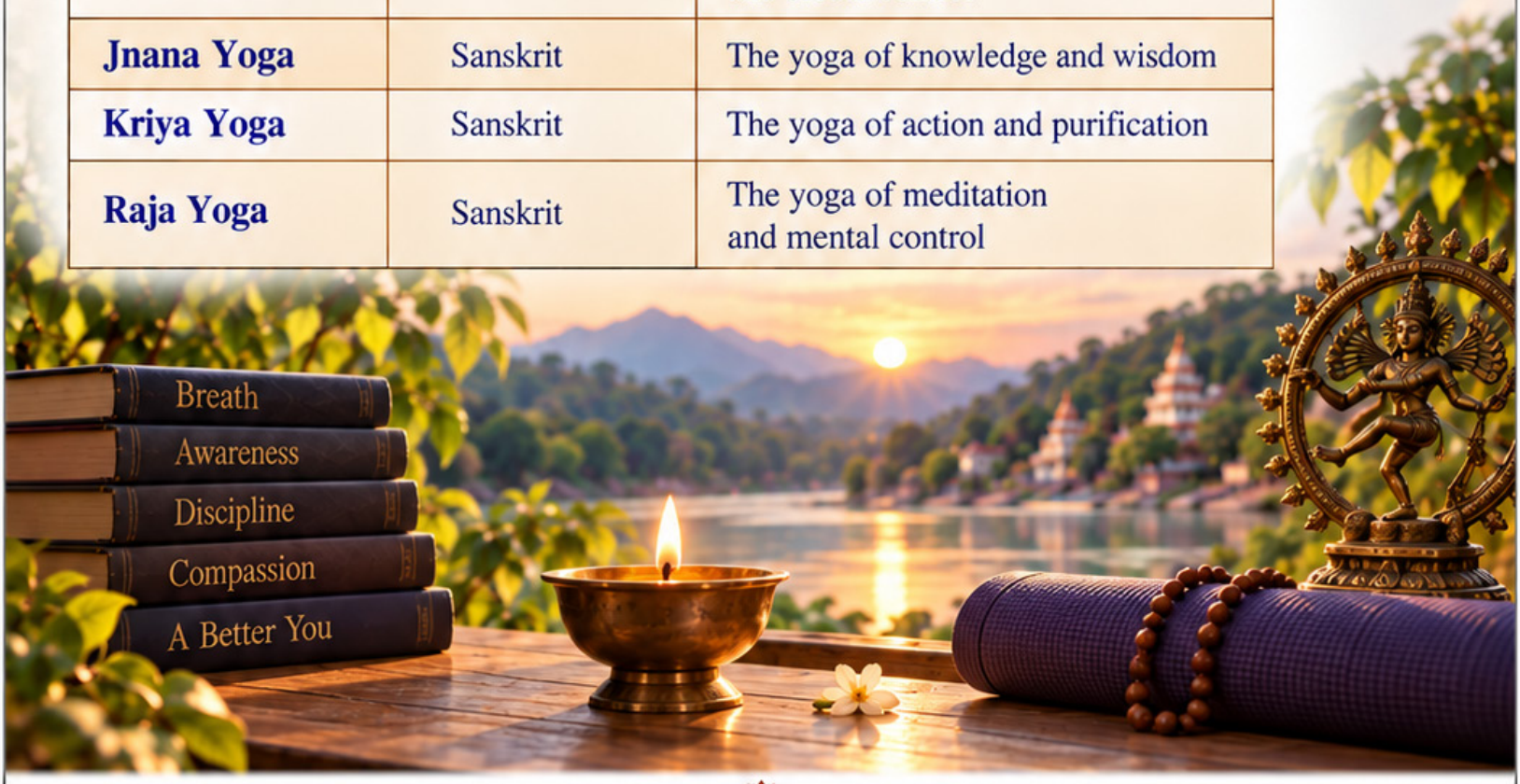
Yours in the connection,

Kailash Nath

GLOSSARY OF SANSKRIT AND TAMIL TERMS

Ancient Wisdom for a Brighter You

Term	Language	Meaning
Ananda	Sanskrit	Bliss; the joy that does not depend on external circumstances
Aagam	Tamil	The inner world; the subjective realm
Advaita	Sanskrit	Not-two; non-duality; the realization that inner and outer are one
Bhakti Yoga	Sanskrit	The yoga of devotion and love
Buddhi	Sanskrit	Intellect; the faculty of discrimination
Dvaita	Sanskrit	Two-ness; duality; the experience of separation
Hatha Yoga	Sanskrit	The yoga of physical postures and breath control
Jnana Yoga	Sanskrit	The yoga of knowledge and wisdom
Kriya Yoga	Sanskrit	The yoga of action and purification
Raja Yoga	Sanskrit	The yoga of meditation and mental control



ABOUT THIS BOOK

The Yoga of Personality is a work of spiritual fiction, inspired by a spoken discourse on personality development and yoga. The original discourse emphasized several core truths:

- Every human being is born unique, and personality development is not about imitating others but about unfolding what is already there.
- Trying to become someone else is an "injustice to the creator."
- Yoga is the science of connection—connecting the inner world to the outer world, the individual to the universal.
- True personality is expressed through creativity, celebration, and living from a space of happiness rather than for happiness.

This book weaves those teachings into the story of Arun Velan, a fictional character whose journey mirrors the struggles and discoveries available to every seeker. The ashram, the characters, and the specific events are fictional, but the wisdom they embody is ancient and universal.

May you, like Arun, stop trying to become a tiger—
and discover the magnificent cat you already are.

THE END

SAME BREATH NEW POSSIBILITIES

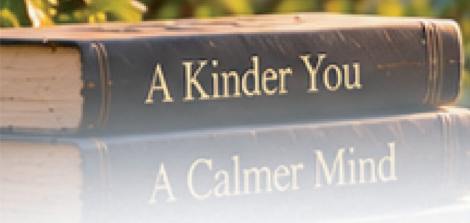
What if the person you are trying to become is not who you're meant to be?

The *Yoga of Personality* is a story about Arun Velan, a young man caught in the endless chase to be someone else. Tired, anxious, and lost in comparison, he escapes to an ashram in Rishikesh, where an extraordinary master, Kailash Nath, shows him a simple but profound truth: personality development is not about imitation, but about embodiment—about becoming who you already are.

Through humor, deep conversations, and life-changing insights, this book explores the true meaning of yoga—not just as physical practice, but as a way of living that connects the inner and outer worlds, transforms pain into growth, and helps us live from a space of happiness, creativity, and celebration.

This is not a self-help manual. It is a journey. A reminder. A gentle invitation to stop becoming someone else—and to discover the magnificent you.

"You are not here to imitate.
You are here to create."



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